

Why it's bad despite being one of the best

VirtualBox, as we've said, is one of the best available software for the purpose. There are no other free and open source products which provide performance like VirtualBox does on every aspect, that too when being completely cross-platform and free of cost! In other words, the value of VirtualBox is unmatched in the virtualization scene for those who simply want great virtualization software for general purpose use without having to spend money. However, just like with any other software, VirtualBox too has its own share of troubles. Here are a few:

- ▶ VirtualBox doesn't provide great support for 3D acceleration. This translates to lack of performance and significant issues if you're planning to use anything inside a VirtualBox guest operating system which would demand DirectX or OpenGL support. We certainly don't recommend running any graphics-intensive applications inside VirtualBox. It would simply not work well. However, for lightweight apps which require some 3D support such as Google Earth, activate the 3D acceleration on the guest machine's display settings and you should be fine.
- ▶ VirtualBox doesn't support split virtual hard disks of smaller sizes. Hence, you must split the files yourself if you want to transport them to another removable media. This isn't a major setback because almost everyone has software like WinZip and WinRar installed on their systems (Linux users should have similar software preinstalled as well). Compressing and splitting your virtual machine's directory shouldn't be a great problem.
- ▶ VirtualBox isn't fun for debugging operating systems. In case you're one of those who love to get inside the code, and deep, get yourself VMware Workstation. VirtualBox won't support a lot of what you'd need there. For example, if you're trying to debug a Windows guest kernel, there are ways in which VMware Workstation can help you do that quite a lot (you should preferably have same version of Windows as both, guest and host, and a deep understanding of the technique). VirtualBox doesn't come with all those hidden features you need when you're getting adventurous with operating system internals.
- ▶ Lack of autoprotect is another thing you might really be missing if you happen to use VirtualBox for some serious work on your virtual machine. Make sure you take snapshots regularly. You don't have automation here.